

# Neo-Expressionism

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**R**enowned for their rather brash figurative paintings, often created with unusual techniques, the Neo-Expressionists emerged in the 1970s in America, West Germany and Italy. Initiated by Georg Baselitz (b.1938), the movement was a revival of Expressionism that rejected the intellectualizing movements of Minimalism and Conceptualism. By the 1980s, it had become the main art movement in the West, generated by new and aggressive forms of promotion and marketing. Neo-Expressionists painted large-scale works in a crude, textural and emotive manner, inspired by Expressionism, Abstract Expressionism and Picasso's late works. The paintings are diverse in appearance, but share common traits, including a rejection of traditional composition and order; tense emotional interpretations of contemporary urban life; vivid, discordant colours; and a primitive style that suggests a sense of inner turmoil. Leading Neo-Expressionists included Americans Julian Schnabel (b.1951) and David Salle (b.1952), Italians Sandro Chia (b.1946) and Francesco Clemente (b.1952), and Germans Baselitz and Anselm Kiefer (b.1945).



Schnabel, *Portrait of Dennis Hopper*, 1999